

# Typing Polytonic Ancient Greek on Windows

## Using Keyman + GreekClassical Keyboard

This tutorial assumes you know the Greek alphabet and what breathings, accents, iota subscript, etc. look like. It assumes **no prior experience** installing programs or changing keyboard settings.

## Step 1: Install Keyman (the keyboard program)

1. Open your web browser and go to:  
<https://keyman.com/windows/download>
2. Click the large green **Download Keyman for Windows** button.
3. When the download finishes, find the file (it will be named something like keyman-18 . . . .exe) in your **Downloads** folder and **double-click** it.
4. Windows may show a warning that the app is not from the Microsoft Store. Click **Install anyway** (or “More info” → “Run anyway”).
5. Click **Yes** if asked for permission to make changes.

6. The installer will download some extra files (this may take 30–60 seconds). Allow it through your firewall if prompted.
7. Click **Install Keyman**.
8. When it finishes, you can click **Start Keyman** or close the window.

You should now see a small Keyman icon in the bottom-right corner of your screen (near the clock).

## Step 2: Install the GreekClassical Keyboard

1. In your browser, go to:  
<https://keyman.com/keyboards/greekclassical>
2. Click the **Install keyboard** button (it should say it installs for Windows).
3. Keyman should open automatically and install the keyboard.

If the direct install doesn't work:

- Download the .kmp file from the page.
- Double-click the .kmp file, or open Keyman Configuration (right-click the Keyman icon → **Configuration**) → **Keyboard Layouts** tab → **Add** → select the .kmp file.

## Step 3: Switch to the Greek Keyboard

1. Look at the bottom right of your screen (language bar, usually shows “ENG” or “US”).
2. Click it.
3. Choose **Keyman** → **Greek Classical** (or similar name).

You can also press **Windows key + Space** to cycle through keyboards quickly.

To switch back to English: Click the language bar again and choose English/US.

**Tip:** You can set a hotkey in Keyman Configuration if you want (e.g., Alt + Z).

## Step 4: Typing Greek Letters

The layout is **mnemonic** — most letters are on keys that sound or look similar to English.

### Common Letter Mappings (lowercase)

- a → α
- b → β
- g → γ
- d → δ
- e → ε

- $z \rightarrow \zeta$
- $h \rightarrow \eta$
- $q \rightarrow \theta$
- $i \rightarrow \iota$
- $k \rightarrow \kappa$
- $l \rightarrow \lambda$
- $m \rightarrow \mu$
- $n \text{ or } v \rightarrow \nu$
- $x \rightarrow \xi$  (or  $j/c$  in some cases)
- $o \rightarrow \omicron$
- $p \rightarrow \pi$
- $r \rightarrow \rho$
- $s \rightarrow \sigma$  (becomes  $\varsigma$  automatically at end of word)
- $t \rightarrow \tau$
- $u \rightarrow \upsilon$
- $f \rightarrow \phi$
- $y \rightarrow \psi$
- $w \rightarrow \omega$

**Capitals:** Hold **Shift** (e.g.,  $\text{Shift} + w \rightarrow \Omega$ )

**To type a normal Latin letter** (e.g., in English words or names):

Type the **backtick** ``` first, then the letter.

Example: ``a`  $\rightarrow$  a (Latin)

## Step 5: Adding Diacritical Marks

**Type the vowel first**, then the diacritic key(s). Order usually doesn't matter, but **best practice** is to use the order (1) letter, (2) breathing, (3) accent, (4) iota-subscript (if any).

## Diacritic Keys

| Mark                 | Key | Name          |
|----------------------|-----|---------------|
| ˊ (rough breathing)  | [   | dasia         |
| ˋ (smooth breathing) | ]   | psili         |
| Ϳ (iota subscript)   |     | ypogegrammeni |
| ¨ (diaeresis)        | +   | dialytika     |
| ` (grave)            | \   | varia         |
| ´ (acute)            | /   | oxia          |
| ˜ (circumflex)       | =   | perispomeni   |
| ˘ (breve)            | -   | vrachy        |
| ¯ (macron)           | _   | macron        |

## Examples

- a / → á
- h [ / → ῥ
- w = | → ω̣
- u + / → ú
- a [ = | → ᾤ (rough + circumflex + iota)

**Sigma** automatically becomes final  $\varsigma$  at the end of a word once you type a space or mark of punctuation.

**Full official chart** (very useful):

<https://help.keyman.com/keyboard/greekclassical> (click the chart link)

## Step 6: Practice & Tips

1. Open Notepad or Word.
2. Switch to the Greek keyboard.
3. Type:  $\varsigma$  e / o s  $\rightarrow$  θεός
4. Type: o i [ = o n  $\rightarrow$  οἶον
5. Experiment with combinations.

### Tips

- Diacritics only attach to vowels (and sometimes *rho*, “ρ”).
- If something looks wrong, just keep typing — it often corrects itself.
- You can re-type a diacritic key to remove or change it in some cases.
- The on-screen keyboard in Keyman can help while learning (right-click Keyman icon  $\rightarrow$  On-Screen Keyboard).

## Troubleshooting

- Keyboard not appearing? Restart Keyman or your computer.

- Diacritics not working? Make sure you're using a font that supports polytonic Greek (most modern fonts do: Times New Roman, Arial, Calibri, etc.).
  - Want to remove Keyman later? Use Windows **Settings** → **Apps** and uninstall it.
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**You're done!** You can now type polytonic Greek anywhere on Windows.

If you get stuck, ask your instructor or check the official help:  
<https://help.keyman.com/keyboard/greekclassical>